

Future of the OpenStreetMap Foundation

SotM-EU 2025

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Gratitude

- STF until end of 2026, ~75,000 GBP plus ~100,000 GBP
- Proton one time 39,000 GBP
- FLOSS/Fund one time 30,000 USD
- one Bitcoin (on time) to 78,000 GBP.

- Equinix, Fastly, and others provide resources for free

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Actual	Projected	WG	Desc	Method
64697.00	152500.00	EWG	Development of iD, Vector Tiles, and website (w/o STF work)	Use budget
116932.00	155909.33	PC	SSRE	Scale by 12/9
18184.00	31977.00	OWG	Hardware and Services for actual operations	Mixed scaling
0.00	30000.00	EWG	Microgrants	Use budget

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Actual	Projected	WG	Desc	Method
2609.00	3000.00	LWG	Legal Fees	Use budget
0.00	4500.00	MWG	CiviCRM work	Use budget
9106.00	12141.33	PC	Accountancy (Q1-Q3)	Scale by 4/3
56252.00	96432.00	PC	Board Executive Support	Scale by 12/7
3035.00	4046.67	Fin	Bank charges (Notably half of which is Fire/Mollie)	Scale by 12/9
-25842.00	0.00	Fin	Bank revaluations (currently surplus)	Ignore
-2121.00	0.00	-	Realised Currency Gains	Ignore
2701.00	3601.33	-	Software Subscriptions (mailbox.org, various yearly, up to 2025-05-01)	Scale by 12/9
0.00	8000.00	-	Legal Fees (Move to EU)	Use budget
238.00	400.00	-	Printing, Postage and Carriage	Use budget
500.00	666.67	-	Professional Fees (St. Johns, 3/4 Quarters)	Scale by 4/3
11012.00	20000.00	Board	Travelling (F2F and SotM)	Use budget

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Actual	Projected	WG	Desc	Method
116160.00	232249.32	-	Membership - Corporate	Mixed scaling
13640.00	16706.71	-	Membership (including by Mollie)	Scale by 365/298
37656.00	47694.14	-	Donations	Mixed scaling
116712.00	139529.00	-	One time large donations (Proton, Bitcoin, FLOSS/Fund)	No scaling

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Expenses (2025, prorated)

370,386	Material Work (w/o STF, SotM)
152,788	Administration
75,000	Sovereign Tech Fund
52,385	State of the Map

Income (2025, prorated)

299,650	Recurring Income
139,529	One-time income
70,000	Sovereign Tech Fund
55,020	State of the Map

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Strategies

Do not significantly reduce expenses:

- fulfill trust of our contractors and mappers
- and it signals to the world that OpenStreetMap is struggling and shrinking.

Reasons to expand spending:

- Executive Director can attract more funding than its own cost
- more SSREs towards 24/7 coverage are self-explanatory
- continue Software Facilitator and the developer beyond the end of STF

Often heard figure of minimal stable org size: 1 million EUR per year

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Communications

- community little interested (thread on community.osm.org)
- get in touch with more potential donors (individuals in the companies)
 - "Automotive does not understand funding of Open Source"

Paper from Frank Nagle: value of Open Source is 8.8 trillion USD
Paper from Accenture: value of OpenStreetMap in 2019 is 1.67 billion USD

Fresher number for this, and how? Task our academic friends to get in touch with economists?

One-page slide that summarizes the Foundation's economics?
What must, shall, and can go there?

Emphasize useful spending:

- Vector Tiles
- the website
- iD editor
- Microgrants

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Spending Goal: Continue STF

This is close to communications: the STF ends in 2026, and we must plan now if we want any form of continuation.

Is it a good driving force as talking point for donations that the Foundation sees the work as a success and its continuation as a low risk high yield endeavour?

Executive Director, Minimum Size

Another strategic option is employ an executive director in the expectation that they will yield more donations than their paycheck.

A quick survey amongst the Corporate Members has been inconclusive: "I'm surprised you do not have one" has been amongst the answers. Which means that even large Corporate Members have comparably little knowledge about actual structures of the Foundation. Which in turn makes the position a non-seller.

However, organizations with an executive director have been notably better at communications.

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Sources

The final and decisive questions are:

Which sources of funding can the Foundation have? Which sources of funding wants the community the Foundation to have?

While some sentiments about the substantial dependency on large US companies have been made, no explicit statement about the maximum size of donors or acceptable versus unacceptable donors has been made. There are efforts under way to get more funding through short term projects amid the STF seen as a huge success story. This is in line with the admiration for the STF expressed at the Open Source Congress. However the point there has been made that if you rely on government project funding then "you have no business model".

How much funding must come from recurring sources to have trust in the Foundation? How much from one-time sources is acceptable?

And to also relay the final topic from the Open Source Congress: a legislation project of the European Commission, the Cyber Resilience Act, has been seen as a mechanism to collect funds from downstream for Open Source infrastructure programs: the vendors, i.e. the system integrators of components need attestations from the makers of the components. This means that commercial users of Open Source must get in touch with the Open Source makers.

Is there an equivalent of the Cyber Resilience Act for OpenStreetMap? Do we want to leverage such a thing?

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